Experiences with and opinions about preprints

Start of Block: Block 1

Q1 Thank you for your interest in our study. The study will help us learn more about the ***usage, reliability, trust*** and ***recognition*** of ***preprints***. Participation in the study consists of completing this questionnaire, which should take about **10-15** minutes. Your participation is **voluntary**, and you may skip any questions that you do not want to answer. Even if you start the questionnaire, you are not required to complete it. You can stop at any time by simply closing your web browser. All responses will remain confidential, and your identity will not be disclosed in any publication. There are **minimal risks** to participants. If you have questions about the study, please feel free to contact Principal Investigators Chaoqun Ni (chaoqun.ni@wisc.edu) and Ian Hutchins (bihutchins@wisc.edu), or by phone at 1-608-263-2900. If you are not satisfied with the response of the research team, have more questions, or want to talk with someone about your rights as a research participant, please contact the University of Wisconsin confidential research compliance line at 1-833-652-2506. **By clicking "Next" below, you consent to participating in this study.**

End of Block: Block 1

Start of Block: Block 3: Overall Impression

Q3 This survey asks about your **experiences** with and **opinions** about **preprints**. **A preprint** is a version of a scholarly or scientific paper that has NOT yet been peer-reviewed and published in a journal or conference. In your opinion, how **popular** are preprints in your field of study?

- ○ Not at all (1)
- ○ A little (2)
- ○ Somewhat (3)
- ○ Very (4)
- ○ Extremely (5)

Q4 Overall, **how much** do you **trust** research results shared as preprints?

- ○ Not at all (1)
- ○ A little (2)
- ○ Somewhat (3)
- ○ Quite a bit (4)
- ○ A great deal (5)

Page Break

Q5 Now, think about the **influence** of preprints on the **scientific community** and **society**. In your opinion, how would you rate the potential positive **impact** of preprints on…

	Not at all (1)	A little (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Accelerating publishing and knowledge sharing (1)	○	○	○	○	○
Promoting open access to research for all audiences (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Allowing for broader community feedback on research (3)	○	○	○	○	○
Promoting collaboration and idea exchange (4)	○	○	○	○	○
Driving the transformation of research evaluation criteria (5)	○	○	○	○	○
Reducing the emphasis on traditional publishing venues like top-tier journals (6)	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

Q55 In your opinion, how would you rate the potential **negative impact** of preprints on…

	Not at all (1)	A little (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Wasting readers' time on unvetted studies (1)	○	○	○	○	○
Increasing the likelihood of malicious use such as spreading misleading or fraudulent information (3)	○	○	○	○	○
Harming research integrity by publishing papers created using tools like large language models (4)	○	○	○	○	○
Harming people's cognition about things or facts (6)	○	○	○	○	○
Weakening public trust in science (7)	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

Page Break

End of Block: Block 3: Overall Impression

Start of Block: Block 4: read and cite

Q8 In the next questions, we ask about your experiences **reading** preprints. Approximately **how many** preprints did you read **every month** in the past **2** years?

- ○ Zero (1)
- ○ 1 to 5 (2)
- ○ 6 to 10 (3)
- ○ 11 to 15 (4)
- ○ More than 15 (5)

Display this question:

If In the next questions, we ask about your experiences reading preprints. Approximately how many pr... != Zero

Q9 How **significant** was each of the following factors in your decision to **read** preprints?

	Not at all (1)	Slightly (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Popularity of reading preprints in your field (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Timeliness of preprints (3)	○	○	○	○	○
Names in the author list of preprints (4)	○	○	○	○	○
Metrics of preprints (e.g., downloads, social media shares or recommendations) (5)	○	○	○	○	○
Your trust in the overall quality of preprints (9)	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

Display this question:

If In the next questions, we ask about your experiences reading preprints. Approximately how many pr... = Zero

Q10 How **significant** was each of the following factors in your decision to **NOT read** preprints?

	Not at all (1)	Slightly (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Unpopularity of reading preprints in your field (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Untimeliness of preprints (3)	○	○	○	○	○
Names in the author list of preprints (4)	○	○	○	○	○
Metrics of preprints (e.g., downloads, social media shares or recommendations) (5)	○	○	○	○	○
Uncertainty in the quality of preprints (9)	○	○	○	○	○

Display this question:

If In the next questions, we ask about your experiences reading preprints. Approximately how many pr... != Zero

Q11 Based on the preprints you have encountered, how would you rate their **overall quality** on the following factors?

	Poor (1)	Fair (2)	Good (3)	Very good (4)	Excellent (5)	NA (6)
Research design (data and methods) (2)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Theoretical foundation (3)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Literature review (4)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Conclusion and discussion (7)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Innovation and novelty (6)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Significance of findings (1)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Compliance to research ethics (9)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Availability of research materials such as data or code (10)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Readability (11)	○	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

Q12 Next, we ask about **citing** preprint articles in your research. In the **past 2 years**, did you **cite** any preprint articles in your research?

- ○ Yes (1)
- ○ No (2)

Page Break

Display this question:

If Next, we ask about citing preprint articles in your research. In the past 2 years, did you cite a... != No

Q14 How **important** was each of the following in your decision to **cite** preprints in your research in the **past 2 years**?

	Not at all (1)	Slightly (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Popularity of citing preprints in your field (1)	○	○	○	○	○
Timeliness of preprints (15)	○	○	○	○	○
Names in the author list of preprints (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Metrics of preprints (e.g., downloads, social media shares or recommendations) (3)	○	○	○	○	○
Compliance to research ethics (5)	○	○	○	○	○
Availability of research materials, such as data or code (6)	○	○	○	○	○
Your trust in the quality of preprints (9)	○	○	○	○	○
Journal/conference requirement (16)	○	○	○	○	○

Display this question:

If Next, we ask about citing preprint articles in your research. In the past 2 years, did you cite a... = No

Q15 How important was each of the following in your decision to **NOT cite** preprints in your research in the **past 2 year**?

	Not at all (1)	Slightly (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Unpopularity of citing preprints in your field (1)	○	○	○	○	○
Untimeliness of preprints (15)	○	○	○	○	○
Names in the author list of preprints (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Metrics of preprints (e.g., downloads, social media posts) (3)	○	○	○	○	○
Noncompliance to research ethics (5)	○	○	○	○	○
Unavailability of research materials, such as data or code (6)	○	○	○	○	○
Uncertainty in the quality of preprints (9)	○	○	○	○	○
Irrelevance of preprints to your research (10)	○	○	○	○	○
Discouraged by journal/institutions/funding bodies (12)	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

End of Block: Block 4: read and cite

Start of Block: Block 5: submit and recognize

Q17 Next, we ask about **submitting** to preprint repositories. In the **past 2 years**, approximately how **many** preprints have you co-authored and **submitted** to preprint repositories?

- ○ Zero (1)
- ○ 1 to 5 (2)
- ○ 6 to 10 (3)
- ○ 11 to 15 (4)
- ○ More than 15 (5)

Page Break

Display this question:

If Next, we ask about submitting to preprint repositories. In the past 2 years, approximately how ma... != Zero

Q18 How **important** was each of the following in your decision to **submit** to preprint repositories in the **past 2 years**?

	Not at all (1)	Slightly (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Receiving open peer reviews (1)	○	○	○	○	○
Documenting iteration history (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Gaining immediate visibility and establishing priority (4)	○	○	○	○	○
Achieving citations and social impacts (5)	○	○	○	○	○
Recommendation by journals/institutions/funding bodies (7)	○	○	○	○	○
Accelerating knowledge dissemination (9)	○	○	○	○	○
Providing open-access outcomes (10)	○	○	○	○	○
Opportunities to disclose results more likely to be unrecognized (3)	○	○	○	○	○

Display this question:

If Next, we ask about submitting to preprint repositories. In the past 2 years, approximately how ma... = Zero

Q19 How **important** was each of the following factors in your decision to **NOT submit** to preprint repositories in the **past 2 years**?

	Not at all (1)	Slightly (2)	Somewhat (3)	Very (4)	Extremely (5)
Lack of recognition for preprints in research evaluation (1)	○	○	○	○	○
Discouraged by journal/institution/funding bodies (2)	○	○	○	○	○
Fear of disseminating unreviewed research that could harm your reputation (4)	○	○	○	○	○
Fear of ideas being plagiarized or scooped (6)	○	○	○	○	○
Potential negative impact on public perception and trust due to premature dissemination of findings (7)	○	○	○	○	○
Collaborators don't want to submit (10)	○	○	○	○	○
Unaware of the option (11)	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

Q26 **How often** did the journals or conferences you submitted to require or encourage that you upload your manuscript to a preprint repository?

- ○ Never (2)
- ○ Rarely (4)
- ○ Sometimes (5)
- ○ Very often (6)
- ○ Extremely often (7)

Page Break

Q21 Consider the potential impact of **submitting preprints** on your **professional development**. In your opinion, how would you rate the **influence** of preprint submissions on your **professional development** in…

	Very negative (8)	Somewhat negative (9)	Neutral (10)	Somewhat positive (11)	Very positive (12)	NA (15)
Opportunities for research collaborations (2)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Gaining citations (4)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Gaining social impact (5)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Prospects for career advancement (e.g. tenure and promotion) (6)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Opportunities of research funding (7)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Publication opportunities in journals or conferences (8)	○	○	○	○	○	○
Other, please tell us (3)	○	○	○	○	○	○

Page Break

Q22 In grant applications, scholars may choose to include their preprint articles as part of their research profiles. In the past **2** years, did you include any of **your own preprints** as part of your **research profile for any grant application**?

- ○ Yes (1)
- ○ No (2)
- ○ I didn't submit any grant applications (3)

Page Break

Display this question:

If In grant applications, scholars may choose to include their preprint articles as part of their re... != No

And In grant applications, scholars may choose to include their preprint articles as part of their re... != I didn't submit any grant applications

Q23 In your experience, compared to **peer-reviewed publications**, how much credit **did** preprints included in your **research profile** receive in **grant reviews**?

- ○ Preprints receive less credit (1)
- ○ Preprints receive about the same credit (2)
- ○ Preprints receive more credit (3)
- ○ Case by case (4)
- ○ Preprints receive no credit (5)

Q24 In your opinion, compared to **peer-reviewed publications**, how much credit **should** preprints included in your **research profile** receive in grant reviews?

- ○ Preprints should receive less credit (1)
- ○ Preprints should receive about the same credit (2)
- ○ Preprints should receive more credit (3)
- ○ Case by case (4)
- ○ Preprints receive no credit (5)

Page Break

Q28 Next, we ask about your experience as **a reviewer** for grant proposals. Have you ever served as a **reviewer** for **grant proposals** (submitted to private or public agencies)?

- ○ Yes (1)
- ○ No (2)

Page Break

Display this question:

If Next, we ask about your experience as a reviewer for grant proposals. Have you ever served as a r... != No

Q33 **How often** have you reviewed grant proposals using preprints as Principal Investigators' (PIs') **representative research achievements**?

- ○ Never (1)
- ○ Rarely (2)
- ○ Sometimes (3)
- ○ Very often (4)
- ○ Extremely often (5)

Display this question:

If Next, we ask about your experience as a reviewer for grant proposals. Have you ever served as a r... != No

Q34 When reviewing research grant applications, compared to peer reviewed publications, how much **credit** do **preprints** used as PIs' representative research achievements **receive** from you?

- ○ Preprints receive less credit (1)
- ○ Preprints receive about the same credit (2)
- ○ Preprints receive more credit (3)
- ○ Case by case - You pay attention to the actual quality of the research (4)
- ○ Preprints receive no credit (5)

Page Break

Q36 Have you ever served as a **committee member** for hiring new faculty or examining faculty's tenure and promotion cases?

- ○ Yes (1)
- ○ No (2)

Page Break

Display this question:

If Have you ever served as a committee member for hiring new faculty or examining faculty's tenure a... != No

Q39 **How often** have you examined potential or current faculty who listed **preprints** as part of their **research achievement** metrics?

- ○ Never (1)
- ○ Rarely (2)
- ○ Sometimes (3)
- ○ Very often (4)
- ○ Extremely often (5)

Page Break

Display this question:

If Have you ever served as a committee member for hiring new faculty or examining faculty's tenure a... = Yes

Q40 When examining potential faculty's **job application** documents, **compared** to peer-reviewed publications, how much **credit** do preprints used as research achievements metrics **receive from you**?

- ○ Preprints receive less credit (1)
- ○ Preprints receive about the same credit (2)
- ○ Preprints receive more credit (3)
- ○ Case by case - I pay attention to the actual quality of the research (4)
- ○ Preprints receive no credit (5)

Display this question:

If Have you ever served as a committee member for hiring new faculty or examining faculty's tenure a... = Yes

Q59 When examining current faculty's **tenure and promotion** documents, **compared** to peer-reviewed publications, how much **credit** do preprints used as research achievements metrics **receive from you**?

- ○ Preprints receive less credit (1)
- ○ Preprints receive about the same credit (2)
- ○ Preprints receive more credit (3)
- ○ Case by case - I pay attention to the actual quality of the research (4)
- ○ Preprints receive no credit (5)

Display this question:

If Have you ever served as a committee member for hiring new faculty or examining faculty's tenure a... != Yes

Q61 In your opinion, compared to **peer-reviewed publications**, how much credit **should preprints** included as one's research output receive in hiring or tenure and promotion evaluations?

- ○ Preprints should receive less credit (1)
- ○ Preprints receive about the same credit (2)
- ○ Preprints receive more credit (3)
- ○ Case by case- I pay attention to the actual quality of the research (4)
- ○ Preprints receive no credit (5)

Page Break

End of Block: Block 5: submit and recognize

Start of Block: Block 6: demographic information

Q42 Finally, we have some questions about you. What is your gender?

- ○ Man (1)
- ○ Woman (2)
- ○ Non-binary (3)
- ○ Not listed, please tell us: (4) _____

Q43 Which **one** of the following best describes the sector in which you currently work?

- ○ Academic, such as universities, colleges, or research institutes (1)
- ○ Industry, such as private companies, corporations, or small businesses (2)
- ○ Government, such as federal or national, state or provincial, or local or municipal (3)
- ○ Non-Governmental Organization (NGO) or Non-Profit (4)
- ○ Freelance, self-employed, or independent (5)
- ○ Education, such as K-12 or equivalent (6)
- ○ Retired or Unemployed (7)
- ○ Other sector, please tell us: (8) _____

Page Break

Display this question:

If Which one of the following best describes the sector in which you currently work? = Academic, such as universities, colleges, or research institutes

Q44 Which **one** of the following best describes your current academic rank or role?

- ○ Assistant professor, or equivalent (1)
- ○ Associate professor, or equivalent (2)
- ○ Full professor, or equivalent (3)
- ○ Teaching faculty, or equivalent (4)
- ○ Research faculty, or equivalent (5)
- ○ Postdoctoral researcher (6)
- ○ Student, seeking doctoral degree (7)
- ○ Student, seeking bachelor's or master's degree (8)
- ○ Other academic rank, please tell us: (9) _____

Q46 In what country is your **primary** affiliation located?

- ○ USA (1)
- ○ Canada (2)
- ○ Other countries (3)

Q47 Which **one** of the following best describes your race?

- ○ American Indian or Native American (1)
- ○ Asian or Pacific Islander (2)
- ○ Black or African (3)
- ○ Hispanic or Latino (6)
- ○ White or Caucasian (4)
- ○ Two or more races (7)
- ○ Another race, please tell us: (5) _____

Page Break

Q48 Which option **best** describes your field of research?

- ○ Animal Behavior and Cognition (4)
- ○ Biochemistry (5)
- ○ Bioengineering (7)
- ○ Bioinformatics (14)
- ○ Biophysics (15)
- ○ Cancer Biology (16)
- ○ Cell Biology (17)
- ○ Developmental Biology (19)
- ○ Ecology (20)
- ○ Epidemiology (21)
- ○ Evolutionary Biology (22)
- ○ Genetics (23)
- ○ Genomics (24)
- ○ Immunology (25)
- ○ Microbiology (26)
- ○ Molecular Biology (27)
- ○ Neuroscience (28)
- ○ Paleontology (29)
- ○ Pathology (30)
- ○ Pharmacology and Toxicology (31)
- ○ Physiology (32)

- ○ Plant Biology (33)
- ○ Synthetic Biology (35)
- ○ Systems Biology (36)
- ○ Zoology (37)
- ○ Behavioral sciences (39)
- ○ Chemistry (40)
- ○ Computer science (41)
- ○ Earth sciences (49)
- ○ Economics and management (42)
- ○ Engineering (43)
- ○ Humanities and arts (44)
- ○ Law (45)
- ○ Mathematics (46)
- ○ Physics and astronomy (47)
- ○ Social sciences (48)
- ○ Other，please tell us (13)

_____

Q63 Which option **best** describes your field of research?

- ○ Animal Behavior and Cognition (4)
- ○ Biochemistry (5)
- ○ Bioengineering (7)
- ○ Bioinformatics (14)
- ○ Biophysics (15)
- ○ Cancer Biology (16)
- ○ Cell Biology (17)
- ○ Developmental Biology (19)
- ○ Ecology (20)
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- ○ Physiology (32)

- ○ Plant Biology (33)
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- ○ Systems Biology (36)
- ○ Zoology (37)
- ○ Behavioral sciences (39)
- ○ Chemistry (40)
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- ○ Humanities and arts (44)
- ○ Law (45)
- ○ Mathematics (46)
- ○ Physics and astronomy (47)
- ○ Social sciences (48)
- ○ Other，please tell us (13)

_____

Q62 Which option **best** describes your field of research?

- ○ Animal Behavior and Cognition (4)
- ○ Biochemistry (5)
- ○ Bioengineering (7)
- ○ Bioinformatics (14)
- ○ Biophysics (15)
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- ○ Engineering (43)
- ○ Humanities and arts (44)
- ○ Law (45)
- ○ Mathematics (46)
- ○ Physics and astronomy (47)
- ○ Social sciences (48)
- ○ Other，please tell us (13)

_____

End of Block: Block 6: demographic information

Start of Block: Block 7

Q58 Anything else you would like to share with us regarding preprints?

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End of Block: Block 7